

Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

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The musical score is written for a four-part setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in F# major and 12/8 time. It consists of four systems of music, each with a treble and bass staff. The lyrics are printed below the vocal staves. Chord symbols are placed above the treble staff of each system. The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#), and the time signature is 12/8. The score includes a variety of musical notations such as eighth notes, quarter notes, and rests, with some notes beamed together. The lyrics are arranged in three lines per system, with the first line of each system starting with a line number (1, 2, or 3).

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,
2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros - per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

in the strife of truth with false - hood, for the good or e - vil side;
they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.
though her por - tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch - ed crust,
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp - fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side

ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp - rous to be just;
nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.
till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de - nied.